

Tunneling

It sounds like something a rodent might do (appropriate on a mouse-driven computer system), but tunneling is really just a handy way to automatically close old windows as you open new ones. Follow along on a simple demonstration.

Close all the open windows except for the main System.Disk window. Now hold down the Option key while you double-click the System folder. As usual, the System window appears—but then the System.Disk window disappears. Congratulations, you have just tunneled!

Using tunneling, you can go deep within your disks' folder structure without ever becoming overwhelmed by the number of open windows on your screen. Try it again—tunnel into the Desk.Accs folder. You're now three "levels" into the System Disk with only one open window!

If you want to go backward along the folder path, the pop-up folder menu comes to the rescue. Hold down the ⌘ and Option keys while you select an item from the pop-up menu, and the current folder will disappear after the new one is opened. This feature is called reverse tunneling. Now you can move up and down through the various "levels" of your disks while keeping only one window open from each disk. As you can imagine, tunneling can considerably ease the confusion caused by a dozen open windows.

⑥ New & Improved

Tunneling and reverse tunneling are new features of System 6.

Windows, Icons, and Directories

When we're working with icons and windows in the Finder, we're really working with directories. A directory is a special file which the computer uses to keep track of all the *other* files on the disk. Each disk has a volume directory, or main directory, that is used to keep track of the files you see when you open the disk. Folders are stored as subdirectories, which are secondary lists of files that appear in the main directory. Subdirectories can, of course, contain other subdirectories.

Note!

ProDOS disks can contain only 51 files in their main directories. Some of these files can be subdirectories, of course, and subdirectories can contain a virtually unlimited number of files. (Under ProDOS, folders are not only useful for organizing your files, they're a necessity for getting around the 51-file limit.). Macintosh (HFS) disks have none of these limitations.

Both the main directory and subdirectories can be generically called directories. The Finder displays the contents of all directories graphically in windows. Main directories are represented by disk icons; subdirectories are represented by folder icons.